THE UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

2021W1 UBC Individual TA Report for ECON 600 L1A - Microeconomics I (Bufang Duan)

Project Title: **2021W1 UBC TA Evaluations**

Course Audience: **25**
Responses Received: **13**
Response Ratio: **52%**

Report Comments

Recommended Minimum Response Rates

Class Size	Recommended Minimum Response Rates based on 80% confidence & ± 10% margin
< 10	75%
11 - 19	65%
20 - 34	55%
35 - 49	40%
50 - 74	35%
75 - 99	25%
100 - 149	20%
150 - 299	15%
300 - 499	10%
> 500	5%

Creation Date: **Wednesday, February 9, 2022**

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TA Questions

Question	N	n	SD	D	N	A	SA	N/A	IM	DI
The TA was helpful when I requested course-related assistance.	25	13	0	0	0	2	11	0	4.9	0.1
The TA was well-prepared for their duties.	25	13	0	0	0	5	8	0	4.7	0.2
The TA was readily available to me either through office hours or by appointment.	25	13	0	0	0	3	10	0	4.9	0.2
The TA communicated at an appropriate level for me.	25	13	0	0	0	3	10	0	4.9	0.2
The TA exhibited interest in the subject matter.	25	13	0	0	0	3	10	0	4.9	0.2
The TA showed knowledge of the subject matter.	25	13	0	0	0	3	10	0	4.9	0.2
The TA presented information clearly.	25	13	0	0	1	3	9	0	4.8	0.3
The TA was effective at stimulating interest in the subject matter.	25	13	0	0	0	4	9	0	4.8	0.2
The TA was receptive to a variety of perspectives and ideas.	25	13	0	0	0	3	10	0	4.9	0.2
The TA treated me and other students with equal respect.	25	13	0	1	0	1	11	0	4.9	0.3
The TA's comments on my written work were helpful.	25	13	0	0	1	2	10	0	4.9	0.2
The TA encouraged intelligent and independent thought.	25	13	0	0	0	3	10	0	4.9	0.2
The TA's evaluation of my work was fair and reasonable.	25	13	0	0	1	2	10	0	4.9	0.2
The TA made a very positive contribution to this course.	25	13	0	0	0	3	10	0	4.9	0.2

Question	%Favourable
The TA was helpful when I requested course-related assistance.	100%
The TA was well-prepared for their duties.	100%
The TA was readily available to me either through office hours or by appointment.	100%
The TA communicated at an appropriate level for me.	100%
The TA exhibited interest in the subject matter.	100%
The TA showed knowledge of the subject matter.	100%
The TA presented information clearly.	92%
The TA was effective at stimulating interest in the subject matter.	100%
The TA was receptive to a variety of perspectives and ideas.	100%
The TA treated me and other students with equal respect.	92%
The TA's comments on my written work were helpful.	92%
The TA encouraged intelligent and independent thought.	100%
The TA's evaluation of my work was fair and reasonable.	92%
The TA made a very positive contribution to this course.	100%

How would you rate the overall contribution of the TA to the course?

N	n	Very poor	Poor	Neutral	Good	Very Good	N/A	IM	DI
25	13	0	0	0	3	10	0	4.9	0.2

Question	%Favourable
How would you rate the overall contribution of the TA to the course?	100%

Of the sessions in which the Teaching Assistant was involved, how often did you attend?

Of the sessions in which the Teaching Assistant was involved, how often did you attend?		
Options	Count	Percentage
None	0	0%
Less than 25%	1	8%
25-50%	1	8%
51-75%	1	8%
Greater than 75%	10	77%

Which, if any, of the following did your Teaching Assistant do? (Please mark each element that is appropriate)

Options	Count
Led discussion-tutorial groups	11
Held office hours	12
marked examination(s)	10
marked essay(s)-assignment(s)	11
gave classroom lectures	4
conducted labs	0
responded to email	9
Respondent(s)	12

Considering everything, how would you rate this course?

N	n	Very poor	Poor	Neutral	Good	Very good	N/A	IM	DI
25	13	1	0	0	4	8	0	4.7	0.4

Question	%Favourable
Considering everything, how would you rate this course?	92%

Please comment on any aspects, positive or negative, of your teaching assistant's (TA's) teaching, attitudes to students, class atmosphere, or any other matters affecting the quality of instruction that you consider worthy of note.

Comments
William was an amazing TA. He knew the material well, came prepared for the tutorials and most of all, was so kind in being available for extra office hour sessions. He responded to emails promptly and was very approachable. I also liked his jokes and sense of humour. My only feedback would be for William not to digress too much during tutorials and office hour sessions. Other than that, I couldn't have asked for a better TA.
William was generally great. I think there may have been some favoritism played toward Chinese students. Also, William once made a joke that a particular student had performed poorly on the test. I happened to know he was joking, but it was in poor taste. William's preferred approach of talking about wrong ways of solving problems instead of the correct way was not helpful to me or some others I talked to, but I suppose others may have found it helpful.
William is a great TA. He loves economics, you can tell. He always finds a clever way to attack a problem, and a curious interpretation to give some intuition to results. He completely masters every possible angle of Microeconomics as far as I can tell. The only humble advice that I can give is to try to be more organized when providing a solution. Try to linearize your train of thought to make it understandable for students that are taking baby steps on things that you are in your domain of knowledge.
I would like to highlight William's great attitude in front of a Ph.D. class. He was always willing to help us and provided excellent guidance.
William was very helpful and clarified many of the topics covered in the lectures.
Overall, William was a great TA. He clearly demonstrated his knowledge of microeconomics through the tutorial sessions and office hours. He was quite generous with his time outside of the allotted office hours/tutorials as well, responding to emails well into the weekend. His help throughout the semester was an immense benefit for my "success" (i.e. hopefully not failing) in this course. And he tried very hard to make a joke in every other sentence. The attempt at humor was greatly appreciated.

Please comment on any aspects, positive or negative, of the format and content of the course as they may have affected the teaching assistant's performance.

Comments
Hard to make up for such a badly–taught class, but William made a lot of things much clearer.
I think that sometimes the official solutions provided to him were unexpected/surprising even for himself. That signals that there might be a design issue in the problem sets. Probably they need to be reassessed and designed more carefully, but of course this is not his fault at all. He excels at his job without any doubt.
All as expected

Explanatory Note

Percent Favourable Rating

This is the percentage of respondents who rated the instructor a 4 or 5 (Agree or Strongly Agree).

Interpolated Median

The data collected for Student Experience of Instruction (SEI) are ordinal in nature, with a natural order (from 1 to 5). While the mean may be used as a measure of central tendency for such data, it is not an appropriate or accurate representation of SEI data (cf. Stark & Freishtat, 2014). The usual measure of central tendency for ordinal data is the median. As a result, we have been reporting the mean and the median for the last several years. After considerable thought and data modeling, we now believe that the interpolated median is the best representation of the data, since it takes the frequency distribution into account.

Consider the following example from 2015W, the two course sections have identical mean (3.8). However, the instructor in section 2 received 77% favourable (4-5) ratings, compared to 53% for the instructor in section 1. The Interpolated median values of (3.7 and 4.2), much better reflects the distribution of the scores above and below their respective median. Furthermore, the interpolated median is better correlated with percent favourable rating; such that an interpolated median of 3.5 on a Likert scale of 1 to 5, corresponds to 50% favourable rating.

Frequency Distribution

Response for University Module Item	Section 1	Section 2
5 = Strongly agree	5	5
4 = Agree	3	5
3 = Neither agree nor disagree	6	0
2 = Disagree	1	2
1 = Strongly disagree	0	1
Mean	3.8	3.8
Median	4.0	4.0

Interpolated Median	3.7	4.2
Percent favourable rating	53%	77%

Dispersion Index

The dispersion index is a measure of variability suitable for ordinal data (Rampichini, Grilli & Petrucci 2004). This dispersion index has values between zero and 1. A zero dispersion index indicates that all respondents in the section rated their experience of instruction the same. An index value of 1.0 is obtained when the respondents are split evenly between the two extreme values (Strongly Disagree & Strongly Agree), a very rare occurrence. In SEI data at UBC, the index rarely exceeds 0.85, and mostly for evaluations not meeting the minimum recommended response rate.